

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer / Specialist | Enterprise Security | Threat Detection and Mitigation |
CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience protecting complex enterprise environments. I specialise in identifying, assessing, and mitigating sophisticated cyber threats across hybrid on-premise and cloud environments, and I have a proven track record of improving detection capabilities and strengthening enterprise-wide security posture at scale. I am experienced working across infrastructure, architecture, and operational teams to deliver lasting security improvements, and I bring hands-on expertise in CrowdStrike Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender, vulnerability management, incident response, and identity and access management. I am seeking a permanent hybrid senior cyber security role within a global organisation where I can help shape and advance the long-term security strategy.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM, Spotlight) -- Expert
- **SIEM and Threat Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, Kusto Query Language (KQL), detection rule engineering, threat hunting
- **Endpoint and Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (M365)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Email Security:** Mimecast
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune, Tanium
- **Security Automation and Orchestration:** Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR), PowerShell scripting, Logic Apps
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat intelligence integration
- **Network Security:** Firewall management (Check Point Harmony), Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS), network segmentation
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security controls, Entra ID governance, cloud identity hardening
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer -- University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 -- Present*

- Responsible for identifying, assessing, and mitigating sophisticated cyber threats across a complex enterprise environment, protecting over 8,000 users across multiple sites and cloud platforms.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) and Microsoft Sentinel SIEM to detect, investigate, and respond to advanced threats, improving detection coverage and reducing dwell time.
- Developed and tuned detection rules and KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel, creating custom analytics rules, workbooks, and automated Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to improve detection and response capabilities.

- Conducted proactive threat hunting across endpoints and cloud environments using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and MITRE ATT&CK threat intelligence, identifying risks before they materialised into incidents.
- Collaborated with infrastructure, architecture, and operational teams to strengthen enterprise security capabilities, providing expert guidance on security controls, configurations, and risk mitigation strategies.
- Managed vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), running regular vulnerability assessments and coordinating remediation to reduce the organisation's attack surface.
- Led enterprise incident response activities under the NIST 800-61 framework, managing containment, eradication, and recovery for security incidents of varying severity.
- Administered Privileged Access Management (PAM) using BeyondTrust and identity controls via Microsoft Entra ID, enforcing least-privilege principles and Zero Trust access across the organisation.
- Oversaw Mimecast email security and firewall management, maintaining protective controls against phishing, malware, and network-based threats.
- Influenced the organisation's long-term security strategy by contributing to security roadmap planning, risk reviews, and framework alignment with NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, and ISO 27001.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity -- University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 -- March 2025

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user enterprise estate, configuring security policies, managing device onboarding, and responding to security alerts.
- Built detection capabilities in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), developing analytics rules and investigating security incidents surfaced through the SIEM platform.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO), strengthening identity security and reducing the risk of credential-based attacks.
- Administered Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing security baselines and compliance policies across endpoints.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, generating risk-rated reports and working with infrastructure teams to drive remediation of critical and high-severity findings.
- Supported BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) implementation, onboarding privileged accounts and enforcing least-privilege access in line with CIS Controls and ISO 27001.
- Developed SOAR automation using PowerShell to streamline repetitive triage and alerting tasks, reducing manual workload and accelerating the team's response to security events.
- Contributed to attaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification, evidencing security controls across endpoint protection, access control, patch management, and network boundary security.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure -- HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 -- March 2022

- Protected security infrastructure for a SaaS/FinTech platform, managing firewall administration, endpoint security, patch management, and identity controls.
- Implemented Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) solutions, reducing unauthorised access risk for a geographically distributed workforce.
- Conducted internal vulnerability assessments and coordinated penetration test remediation, working with development and infrastructure teams to close identified risks in line with agreed timelines.
- Managed Mobile Device Management (MDM) controls and device compliance, maintaining secure endpoint standards across the organisation's estate.
- Maintained security policies aligned with ISO 27001 and operational security best practices in a fast-moving SaaS environment.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Successfully deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across the UAL enterprise, delivering advanced endpoint protection and enabling real-time threat detection and proactive threat hunting.
- Led Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployment across 8,000 users, significantly improving endpoint detection and response coverage across the organisation.

- Improved the organisation's threat detection capabilities by building custom Microsoft Sentinel detection rules and KQL queries, reducing false positives and surfacing genuine threats more effectively.
- Deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), enforcing least-privilege principles and reducing the organisation's privileged account attack surface.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating the organisation's compliance with the UK government's cyber security standard across five key control areas.
- Developed and delivered enterprise-wide security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes, measurably reducing the human risk factor within a large and diverse user community.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Surrey/South-East England, UK)